Immutable mount destinations for runtime qualification

Source-only proposal addressing the retained Q1 writable-layer failure. No image build, container action or qualification retry was performed. The old failure remains a failed case and its exact diff and receipt are archived here.

Retained Q1	Source amendment	Contract preserved	Status
Positive program exit 0	Two copy-only inputs	Empty diff required	Not built or tested
Empty-diff check failed	Immutable destinations	Same qualifier checks	Review before admission

Observed boundary. The prior positive diagnostic exited zero and reported the required pre-exec pids limit, then the strict empty Docker diff check rejected added /fixtures, /qualification and /qualification/exec-gate. The qualifier mounts the fixture directory and standalone gate read-only at those destinations. The retained runtime Dockerfile copies the recovery payload but does not explicitly install these destinations. These facts identify mount-destination creation as a candidate cause; they do not prove the proposed image will pass qualification.

Proposed construction. Add two COPY instructions, with explicit root ownership, to the existing copy-only runtime overlay. One empty marker creates /fixtures in an immutable image layer; one empty nonexecutable file creates /qualification/exec-gate. The context files have mode 0644. Existing runtime payload, base-image argument, user and entrypoint remain unchanged. No RUN instruction executes image code during assembly. Active qualification still supplies the actual fixtures and executable gate as the existing read-only mounts, obscuring the placeholders.

Acceptance remains strict. No whitelist is added to Docker diff, no failed record is relabeled, and no success is inferred from exit zero alone. The qualifier source hash is pinned and remains unchanged. A prospective runtime test must still return an empty writable-layer diff and pass its existing identity, digest, output, limits and cleanup checks. Unexpected directory metadata changes may still fail; only a fresh admitted run can resolve that.

Review and binding requirements. Independently inspect the literal recipe delta, context-file bytes/modes, copy-only behavior, missing-mount behavior, and whether preexisting image destinations can preserve the empty-diff contract. Before any execution, reconcile the old image/container owners, bind the exact base and context, establish a new final image ID and rebind the unchanged qualifier to it. Preserve old image and receipt identities. No publication permission for different image bytes or new scientific budget is inferred from earlier approvals. The prior one-attempt assembly and qualification limits are not silently renewed.

Next action. Obtain source review of this concrete amendment, then prepare an exact bounded execution request only after the recipe/context and admission bindings are complete. The proposed mechanism is untested. This packet supplies no runtime pass, cohort result or cost ratio, and leaves the 1,260-target scope and expired campaign deadline unchanged.